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The third sector of generalized reciprocity, where significant wealth differential exists, is only applicable to the G/wi case in the context of interband alliances functioning as "drought relief." I refer here to the practice of joint migration into the territory of an allied band that has enjoyed a good season when one band has suffered localized drought in its own territory. Although this is certainly not balanced reciprocity in the sense that the migrating band gives its hosts anything in direct return for the succor received, things even out in time — or at least they are supposed to in the vernacular model — when the migrants find themselves hosts to other drought-stricken bands in the future. This, then, is comparable with the generalized-balanced reciprocity that occurs in the circle of initiation mates, joking partners, and others.

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Sahlins's contention that staple foods are insulated from the rest of the exchange network is, of course, true of gathered foods in the G/wi case. It is not valid for the meat of larger game. Sahlins implies that food giving for "sociability" purposes is somehow different from other exchanges and ought, therefore, to constitute a separate category. It is my contention that media other than food are inserted into, and a large part of the exchange network is at times occupied with, transactions that have sociability as their main purpose, but that these, too, have economic significance. These transactions exhibit no formal or other distinctive characteristics. They can only be recognized after examination of the recipients' pragmatic need for that which is given. I can see only confusion coming from their being treated as a special case or series of special cases. As I have said, Sahlins himself seems undecided about the singularity of "sociability" exchanges, as he unequivocally includes in normal balanced reciprocity those exchanges that mark alliances, friendship, and so on (1965:176 ff.) and his view would be difficult to sustain in a situation [255](#) of competitive sociability in a sort of

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inverted negative reciprocity. It seems clear that the G/wi consider meat an exchange medium that may be used with all propriety in exchanges characterized by generalized as well as balanced reciprocity.

Human Relations Area Files

755 Prospect Street

New Haven, CT 06511

General Inquiries:  hraf@yale.edu

Issues and Bugs:  hraf-support@yale.edu



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